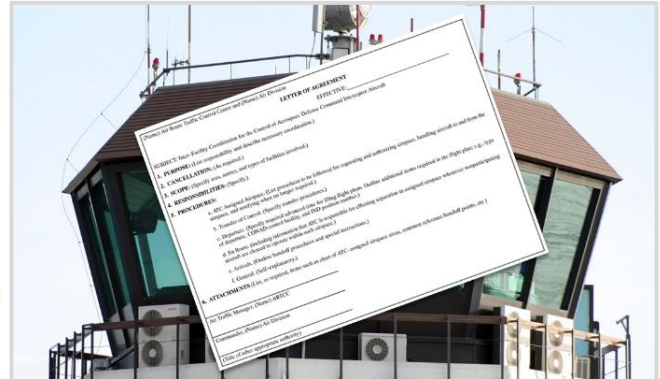


BASICS FOR AIR TRAFFIC CONTROL – INTRODUCTION TO LETTERS OF AGREEMENT (LOAs) AND STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES (SOPs)

INTRODUCTION

Letters of Agreement (LOAs) and Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) define specific agreements and operating procedures established between your facility and other persons, facilities, and organizations or operational procedures within your facility. To do your job effectively, you will need to know what these documents are and how they affect your work.

This module describes LOAs between air traffic facilities and other government/nongovernment entities and SOPs within air traffic facilities.



INTRODUCTION TO LETTERS OF AGREEMENT (LOAs) AND STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES (SOPs)

Purpose: This lesson explains the purpose and content of LOAs and SOPs.

Objectives:

- Define purposes of LOAs and SOPs
- Identify content of LOAs and SOPs

References for this lesson are as follows:

- FAA Order JO 7210.3, Facility Operation and Administration
- FAA Order 1320.1, FAA Directives Management



Facilities use LOAs to standardize operations or procedures that require the cooperation of other entities, such as airport management, local communities, and other ATC facilities.

An Air Traffic Control Tower (ATCT) Facility will normally have LOAs with the entities shown here.

LOAs Between ATCT(s) and Other Entities

Military Facilities	- Describe procedures to satisfy requirements in support of a branch of military service - Define stereotyped flight plans used for special operations, including: - Training flights - Flight test programs - Describe airspace areas required to segregate special operations
Local Owners/Operators	- Establish aircraft call signs to be used in radiotelephony communications between ATC and the local operators - Describe airspace areas required to segregate special operations
Other ATC Facilities (Interfacility Coordination)	- Supplement established operational/procedural instructions - Define radar handoff procedures and Transfer of Control/Communications Points (TCPs) - Define responsibilities and coordination requirements for tower en route control service - Delegate responsibility for ATC service, including: - Approach control service - Control boundary jurisdiction - Procedures for coordinating and controlling aircraft where two or more airports have conflicting traffic patterns - Responsibility for IFR controlled jurisdiction - Establish or standardize operating methods for special VFR operations - Specify special operating conditions or specific air traffic control procedures
Airport Management <i>Tower / TRACON are NOT the "same" facility as the airport they may be housed on</i>	- Establish responsibilities for: - Operating airport equipment - Providing emergency services - Providing braking action reports - Reporting operating limitations - Reporting hazards - Define movement and non-movement areas and associated responsibilities



Air Traffic Control Facility/Terminal Radar Approach Control (ARTCC/TRACON) will normally have LOAs with the entities shown here.

LOAs Between ARTCC/TRACON and Other Facilities

Military Facilities	■ Describe procedures to satisfy requirements in support of a branch of military service contained in FAA JO 7110.65 or FAA JO 7110.10 ■ Define stereotyped flight plans used for special operations, including: • Training flights • Flight test programs ■ Describe airspace areas required to segregate special operations
Other ATC Facilities (Interfacility Coordination)	■ Supplement established operational/procedural instructions ■ Define radar handoff procedures and Transfer of Control/Communications Points (TCPs) ■ Define responsibilities and coordination requirements for tower en route control service ■ Delegate responsibility for ATC service, including: • Approach control service • Control boundary jurisdiction • Procedures for coordinating and controlling aircraft where two or more airports have conflicting traffic patterns • Responsibility for IFR controlled jurisdiction ■ Establish or standardize operating methods for special VFR operations ■ <u>Specify special operating conditions or specific air traffic control procedures</u>

Review and Approval

The reviewing and approving authority for LOAs is the Service Area Office but may be delegated to:

- Air Traffic Representative (ATREP)
- Air Traffic Manager (ATM) or designee
- Region Air Defense Liaison Officer (RADLO)



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LOA Format

ACADEMY ATCT AND ACADEMY CITY

LETTER OF AGREEMENT

EFFECTIVE: October 1, 2016

SUBJECT: Airport Operations (Informal Noise Abatement Requirements and Recommendations, and Recommended Arrival and Departure Procedures)

1. **PURPOSE:** To establish noise abatement procedures used on or in the vicinity of the Academy Airport.

Contains the responsibility and describes the necessary conditions

2. **CANCELLATION:** Cancels previous agreement dated October 1, 1993

As required

3. **SCOPE:** The procedures outlined herein are for use in the conduct of arriving and departing aircraft in conjunction with the informal noise abatement agreement.

Contains the specific area, names, and types of facilities involved

4. **RESPONSIBILITIES:** The Academy Airport ATCT shall use the procedures outlined herein, weather and safety permitting.

Contains specific responsibilities

5. **PROCEDURES:**

A. INFORMAL NOISE ABATEMENT REQUIREMENTS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

- (1) Runway 16/34 closed to all heavy jet operations.
- (2) Runway 16/34 closed to all operations daily between the hours 2300 and 0700 local time.

B. RECOMMENDED ARRIVAL AND DEPARTURE PROCEDURES

- (1) Weather and safety permitting, aircraft should not descend below pattern altitudes for the particular runways until further descent is required for landing.
- (2) Large and heavy departures maintain runway heading until reaching 1,500 feet MSL before starting turns.
- (3) Turbojets and aircraft in excess of 12,500 lb GWT are requested to fly at least a three (3) mile final to the parallel runways.
- (4) When approving deviations from published patterns, consider these deviations first from a safety standpoint and second from a noise standpoint.

Contains pertinent items such as maps, charts, etc.

6. **ATTACHMENTS:** None

*Ex. Map, graph, etc.
Supporting Documents*

Contains all the information and instructions necessary to accomplish the subject

✓ Knowledge Check A

REVIEW what you have learned so far about LOAs. ANSWER the questions below.

1. The responsibility for approval of an LOA rests with the _____. (Select the correct answer.)
 - ☒ Service Area Office
 - ☐ Flight Inspection Field Office
 - ☐ General Aviation District Office
2. Which of the following may be delegated the authority to approve an LOA? (Select all correct answers that apply.)
 - ☒ Air Traffic Representatives
 - ☒ Air Traffic Managers
 - ☒ Region Air Defense Liaison Officer

SOP Elements

Standard Operating Procedure

While LOAs are for **interfacility** use (between facilities), SOPs are for **intrafacility** use (within the same facility). Facility SOPs specify, at minimum:

- The required procedures for maintaining a safe and efficient operation
- The jurisdictional boundaries for each operational position/sector

SOP Format

Most SOPs contain the same major elements common to directives:

- Introduction
- Content
- Administration information



SOP Content

SOPs are usually located in facility directives. In addition to defining operating position responsibilities and sector boundaries, SOPs may specify procedures for:



Knowledge Check B

REVIEW what you have learned so far about SOPs. ANSWER the questions below.

- What is the purpose for having an SOP? (Select the correct answer.)
 - ☒ Specify jurisdictional boundaries for each position/sector
 - ☐ Establish coordination between facilities
 - ☐ Coordinate between government and nongovernment facilities
- Which of the following would **NOT** require the development of an LOA? (Select the correct answer.)
 - ☐ Interfacility coordination
 - ☒ Intrafacility coordination
 - ☐ Airport emergency services
- Which of the following examples would **NOT** be contained in an SOP? (Select all correct answers that apply.)
 - ☐ Local procedures for food and beverages
 - ☐ Equipment usage
 - ☒ Define roles and responsibilities with airport management
 - ☐ Position/Sector descriptions
 - ☐ Internal coordination procedures between positions
 - ☒ Approach control services
 - ☐ Position relief briefing
- Which of the following material or content would appear as part of an LOA? (Select all correct answers that apply.)
 - ☐ Equipment usage
 - ☒ Tower en route control service
 - ☐ Position/Sector descriptions
 - ☐ Internal coordination procedures between positions
 - ☒ Special VFR operations
 - ☐ Position relief briefing

SUMMARY

This module explained the purpose and content of LOAs and SOPs.

In accordance with FAA Order JO 7210.3, Facility Operation and Administration and FAA Order 1320.1, FAA Directives Management, you should now be able to:

- Define purposes of Letters of Agreement (LOAs) and Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)
- Identify content of Letters of Agreement (LOAs) and Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)

KNOWLEDGE CHECK ANSWER KEY

Knowledge Check A

1. Service Area Office; 2. Air Traffic Representatives, Air Traffic Managers, Regional Air Defense Liaison Officer

Knowledge Check B

1. Specify jurisdictional boundaries for each position/sector; 2. Intrafacility coordination; 3. Define roles and responsibilities with airport management, Approach control services; 4. Tower en route control service, Special VFR operations